

What's good and what's not about WiFi

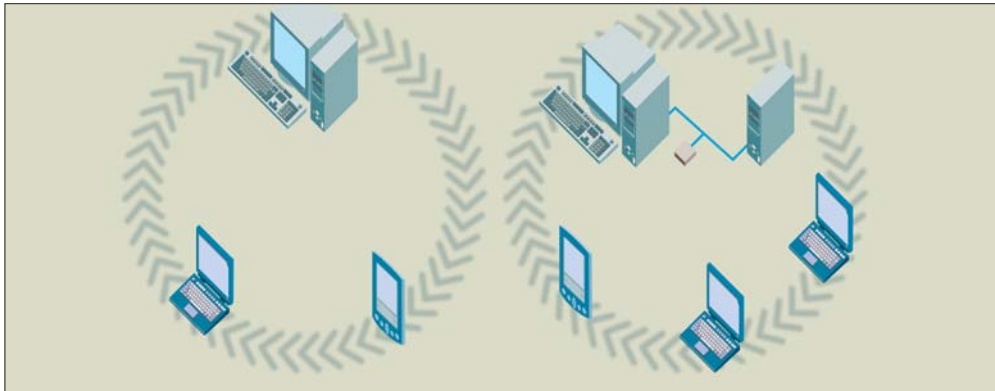
- WiFi is best suited for corporates with several employees moving about the office with their laptops.
- Homes looking for a means to share a broadband Internet connection can also consider adopting WiFi.
- WiFi may be widely used for communication between computers, and there are PDAs that support it. It's also possible to add WiFi support to a PDA by inserting a WiFi card into the SD (Secure Digital) slot.
- In offices with lots of switches etc., WiFi can help the administrator. If these

devices—the switches and so on—are Wi-Fi equipped, the administrator can monitor the devices remotely.

- A WiFi setup is more expensive than a regular LAN.

■ The major problem with WiFi is the high power consumption, which some mobile devices just can't afford. WiFi drains batteries, fast. PDA users should avoid using it, especially if they have a Bluetooth option.

- Security is not very easy, since it is difficult to control access to the network.



WiFi: What you need to know

For a system to connect to a WiFi network, it needs to have a WiFi network card, or an access point, connected to it. WiFi network cards are like regular network cards that plug into PCI slots, but have an antenna. It's also possible to plug an external WiFi adapter into a USB port. Once the network cards are installed and configured, the system can connect to any WiFi network.

Hardware access points can be connected to network equipment such as a bridge, or they can be connected to a system that has access to a wired network. It's also possible to install software that converts the system into an access point. Hardware access points are generally used in commercial hot spots, while software access points are used to share an Internet connection in homes and SoHos.

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